

The Culture of Business, Finance and the Economy

Class 14 –7 may

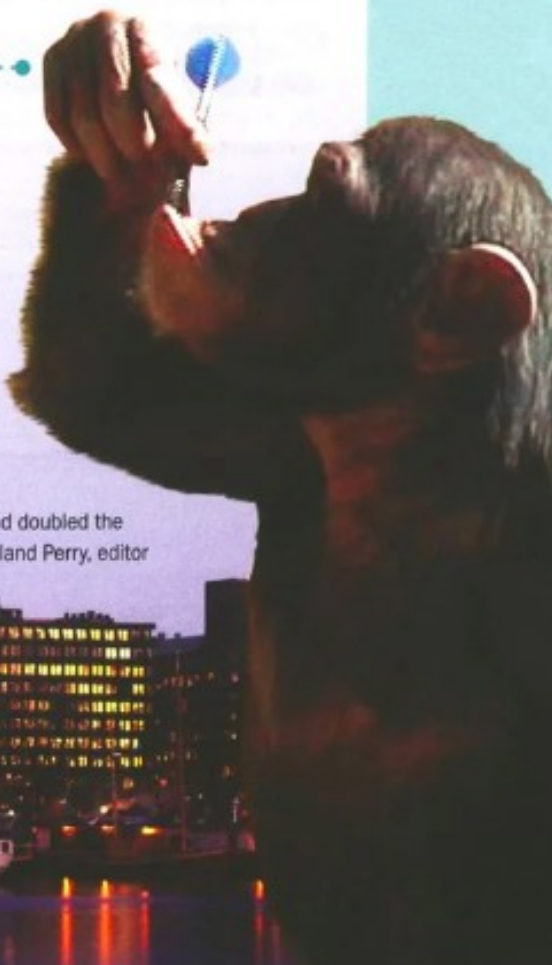
Dr. Juan M. del Nido
First semester 2026

Today

Financial Analysts I: what they are for and how to become one

★ MOST SUCCESSFUL CHIMPANZEE ON WALL STREET

Raven, a six-year-old chimpanzee, became the 22nd most successful money manager in the USA after choosing her stocks by throwing darts at a list of 133 internet companies. The chimp created her own index, dubbed MonkeyDex, and in 1999 delivered a 213% gain – outperforming more than 6,000 professional brokers on Wall Street. “She quadrupled the performance of the Dow and doubled the performance of the Nasdaq composite,” said Roland Perry, editor of the *Internet Stock Review*.



Recap

Consultants I, II, III, IV

**Financial analysis tries to understand
markets and help banks, companies,
investment funds and individuals make
investment decisions**

class 3: some among us have unique knowledge to “read” complex phenomena





1.er semestre

- Matemática I
- [Economía I](#)
- Contabilidad Básica
- Instituciones Políticas y de Gobierno
- Comprensión de Textos y Escritura

- Introducción a la Estadística
- Introducción al Derecho
- [Microeconomía](#)
- Economía Matemática

2.º semestre

- Matemática II
- [Economía II](#)
- Historia de Occidente a partir de la Modernidad
- Problemas Filosóficos

- [Análisis Estadístico](#)
- Historia Económica Internacional
- [Macroeconomía](#)
- [Tópicos de Microeconomía](#)

STORIES OF CAPITALISM

INSIDE THE ROLE OF
FINANCIAL ANALYSTS

STEFAN LEINS

Leins asks

**Are financial analysts really able to
read and understand the market in
exceptional ways?**

ECONOMETRICA

JOURNAL OF THE ECONOMETRIC SOCIETY

*An International Society for the Advancement of Economic
Theory in its Relation to Statistics and Mathematics*

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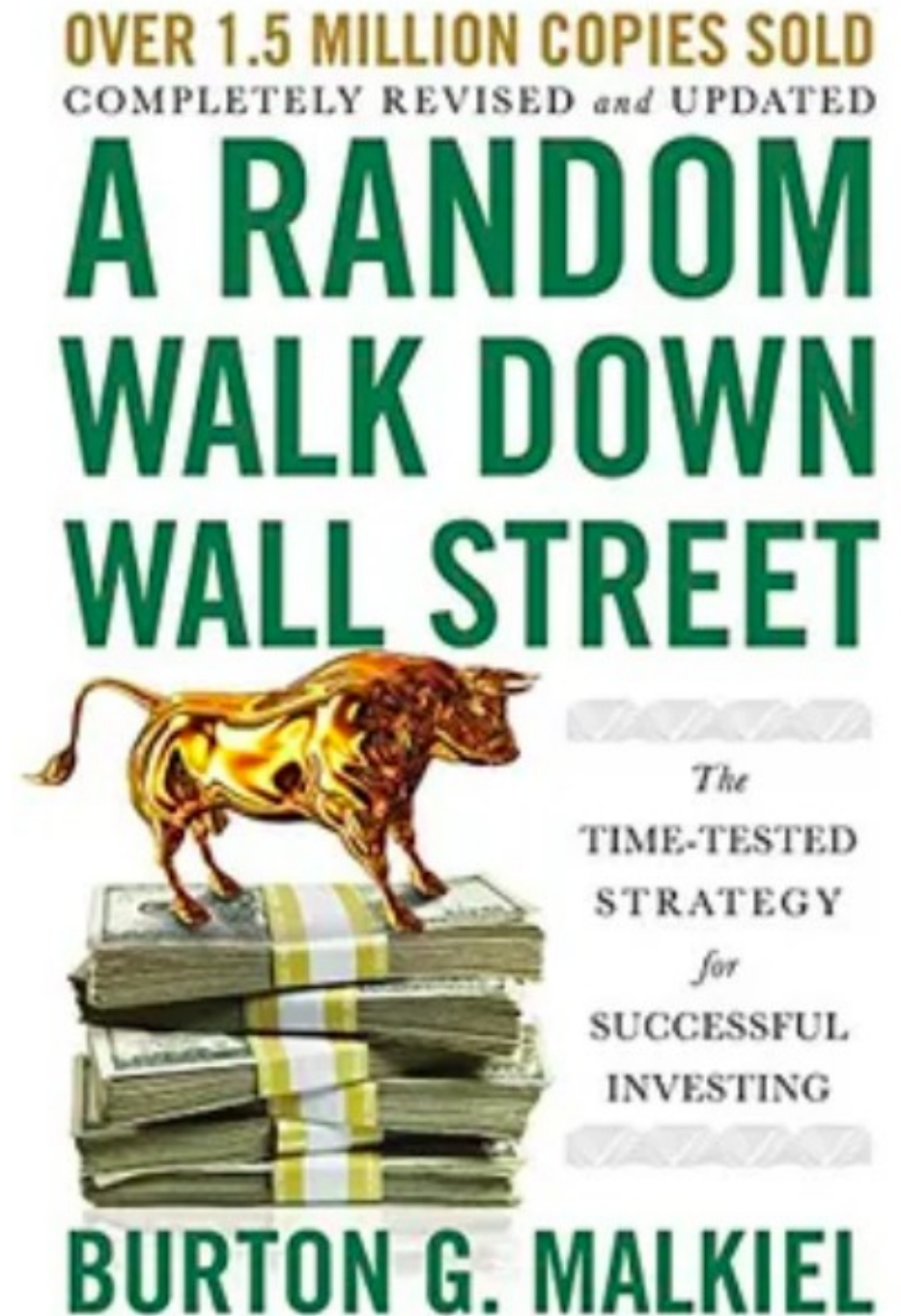
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Working (1934), Kendall (1953), and Osborne (1959) empirically tested this and concluded that, on average, financial analysts are largely **unable to outperform the market.**

**“a blindfolded monkey
throwing darts at a
newspaper’s financial
pages could select a
portfolio that would do
just as well as one
carefully selected by
experts.” (Malkiel,
1973)**



January 1999

★ MOST SUCCESSFUL CHIMPANZEE ON WALL STREET

Raven, a six-year-old chimpanzee, became the 22nd most successful money manager in the USA after choosing her stocks by throwing darts at a list of 133 internet companies. The chimp created her own index, dubbed MonkeyDex, and in 1999 delivered a 213% gain – outperforming more than 6,000 professional brokers on Wall Street. “She quadrupled the performance of the Dow and doubled the performance of the Nasdaq composite,” said Roland Perry, editor of the *Internet Stock Review*.



Chimpanzee actress Raven (Babe, Pig in the City) threw 10 darts at a dartboard of 133 companies. Within six trading days, one of her picks was up a whopping 95%. By the year's end, Raven's "portfolio" had outperformed over 6,000 internet and technology money managers earning an astonishing 213% return.

2003 - 2009

The Chicago Sun-Times published annual stock market forecasts from “investment expert” Adam Monk. Adam randomly pointed to five stocks listed in the financial section of a newspaper at the beginning of each year. Outperforming the indexes four years in a row, from 2003-2006, Monk’s 2008 portfolio only lost 14% while most money managers lost upwards of 35%.

In 2006, Jim Cramer, a well-known analyst with the television network CNBC, challenged Adam Monk. He failed: in 2006 and in 2008, the monkey managed to beat Cramer.



Mark King

Sun 13 Jan 2013 06.59 GMT

 **Share**

 **96**

Investments: Orlando is the cat's whiskers of stock picking

Ginger moggy beats the professionals and a team of students in the Observer's share portfolio challenge



Leins

**If these people have been empirically proved to be wrong
as often as they are right and monkeys and cats
outperform them...**

**... how come financial analysts exist? What are they really
there for? How does their work fit the broader economy
and the cultural shape of our economies broadly
speaking (government, institutions, private sector,
NGOs)?**

Zurich born and raised, Leins spent 2 years inside “Swiss Bank” in Zurich, starting in 2010, studying “how being a financial analyst work”

The answer

They're not there to be "right"

They're there to make things *make sense*

Paradeplatz, Zurich



How to become a financial analyst?

If you want to succeed as a young banker on Wall Street, there are some fairly strict preconditions. You have to be pleasant, polite, and attentive to detail. You have to be able to work three consecutive twenty-hour days without having a nervous break-down or falling asleep on your keyboard. You have to know how to calculate the net present value of future cash flows, how to make small talk about the Yankees, and, ideally, how to write a coherent memo to your boss after your third Jäger bomb. [...] But most important, you have to be handy with an Excel spreadsheet.

(Kevin Roose Young Money, 2014, ix)

In Switzerland

University networks

Most of the eighteen regular analysts at Swiss Bank are University of Zurich or University of St. Gallen, the two universities with the best networks to the Swiss banking industry. All have a masters degree. Other bankers are mostly macroeconomists, but most financial analysts studied banking and finance.

Recruiting at UZH



Break



Build your Early Career in Banking at Citi in Switzerland

03.10.2024
16:15 - 17:45

UZH
SOE-E-7

Swiss Bank's management asked two employees to talk about Africa as a continent for future investments. Andy talked about the growing cell phone industry in Africa. Daniel, a wealth manager specializing in socially responsible investing, presented a market outlook for African microfinance institutions. Swiss Bank's commitment to African markets and microfinance was not that significant in terms of real investments. Rather, the point was to present the bank's business as something exciting and exotic that goes beyond mere economics.

Also, by handing out freebies and offering wine and expensive finger food, Swiss Bank cultivated the image of being a place where the students could enter a world of wealth and luxury. I spoke to some of the students who participated: most were highly enthusiastic about the opportunity to combine the luxurious and the socially meaningful.

During such events, senior analysts and people from Swiss Bank's human resources department search for individuals who can be recruited to become financial analysts. Aside from grades, the recruiters look for self-confident, rhetorically strong, competitive students.

(Consultants, class 11: Recent graduates from top universities. Not because of our skill, intelligence or experience but because we were ambitious, respected hierarchy and had been trained into working long hours towards clearly defined deadlines.)



Financial Analyst Program (Europe - Zug, Switzerland)

Partners Group • Baar, Switzerland

- Outstanding academic credentials
- Strong analytical and quantitative skills
- Independent thinking with problem-solving mindset
- Excellent interpersonal and written communication, combined with a strong work ethic and professional demeanor
- Relevant internship experience (in the financial industry and/or elsewhere)
- A collaborative team-player attitude

2026 Global Private Bank - Advisor Analyst Training Program - Zurich

JPMorgan Chase & Co. • Zurich, Switzerland

Required qualifications, capabilities, and skills

- An expected graduation date between December 2025 to June 2026
- Highly driven person who enjoys working in teams to develop complex solutions
- Exceptional interpersonal, communication, logical thinking and problem-solving skills
- Excellent organizational skills and ability to multitask
- Genuine interest in financial markets and macro-level economic trends
- Desire to ultimately work with external clients in a relationship building and sales capacity
- Ability to thrive in a fast-paced, collaborative environment
- Highly inquisitive, focused and considerate
- Good judgment and discretion when working with confidential information
- Fluency in Russian or German may be required

Compare - McKinsey

YOUR QUALIFICATIONS AND SKILLS

Typically enrolled in advanced graduate degree program (e.g., MBA, PhD, etc.); Requirements may vary by country or practice.

Strong communication skills, both verbal and written, in English and local office language(s), with the ability to adjust your style to suit different perspectives and seniority levels.

Ability to create work product-focused materials / outputs, which may include PowerPoint decks, Excel models, articles, or other written deliverables.

Ability to work or attend meetings outside of traditional business hours or take on projects with limited or no notice at times.

Excellent organization capabilities, including the ability to initiate tasks independently and see them through to completion.

Proficient in rational decision making based on data, facts, and logical reasoning.

Exceptional time management to meet your responsibilities in a complex and largely autonomous work environment.

Ability to travel to and work in varying environments that may be challenging and/or not accessible (e.g., factories, hospitals, mines).

Marcel identifies a good future analyst by asking at the beginning of an event whether **someone would like to summarize the event at the end of the day.**

Those willing to do this become part of Marcel's focus group. Also, if **a student actively approaches him or one of the other representatives of Swiss Bank during the event, he or she is more likely to be given the chance to start a career as a financial analyst.**

These events are for bachelor's degree students. Selected students are offered a summer internship, where students get to know Swiss Bank as an organization and learn the basics. In comparison with other internships, they are very well paid, which means they can temporarily live the life of a Swiss banker. Usually, the students move to the city of Zurich during this time.

Students are tested on whether they can adopt the lifestyle of a financial analyst. They come at about 7:00 a.m. and stay until 6:00 p.m. The reason is not the workload: everyone knows **it would be possible to do the daily tasks without doing any overtime**. Arriving early and leaving late is a way for them to show that they are committed to becoming financial analysts. Marcel encourages interns to work overtime **as a sign of commitment**,

Ability to work or attend meetings outside of traditional business hours or take on projects with limited or no notice at times.

Ability to travel to and work in varying environments that may be challenging and/or not accessible (e.g., factories, hospitals, mines).

After the summer internship, Marcel usually encourages the students to go back to the university to earn a master's degree. After having accomplished the master's degree, candidates—regardless of whether they interned at Swiss Bank—have to go through an extensive recruitment process. If their initial application is accepted, they have to be assessed online. The online assessment measures interpersonal, numerical, and linguistic skills.

Junior Financial Analyst Job Requirements

Here are some requirements for the role of a junior financial analyst:

Education

Most employers usually require candidates applying for the role to have an undergraduate degree in finance, commerce or accounting from a recognised university. Candidates with degrees in mathematics or statistics are also eligible for the financial analyst position because of their firm foundation in quantitative analysis and strong [analytical skills](#) [↗](#). Some may also take additional certification courses to improve their skills and employability. Here are some standard certifications you can consider:

Those who passed the online assessment are invited to a job interview, followed by two additional interviews. The questions posed during these interviews do not follow a standard rule. Marcel usually started the first interview by asking them about the gross domestic product of Ghana and a number of other non-European countries. The focus is not so much on their academic achievements, but on their rhetorical skills, imagination, and self-confidence.

Few candidates have any idea about the GDP of Ghana, and so they have to come up with an estimation and a story that supports it. Thus, this exercise tests one of the most important skills in financial analysis: the ability to construct a coherent narrative.

Once offered a position at Swiss Bank, senior analysts encourage the new members to pursue a chartered financial analyst (CFA) credential. This involves passing three examinations, each one requiring the memorizing of three to five finance textbooks. This is challenging: junior staff have long working hours, and so they have to study for the examinations on weekends and during their vacation time. Passing the CFA, however, is a strong signal of expertise.

Compare with consultants

- **Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA):** The certification assesses a candidate's proficiency in areas such as investment management, financial analysis and portfolio management. Candidates with a bachelor's degree or in the final year of their undergraduate programme are eligible to apply.
- **Certified Management Accountant (CMA):** The certification determines a candidate's knowledge and experience in financial planning and analysis, cost management and [performance management](#). Candidates with a bachelor's degree in finance or a related field with at least two years of experience are eligible to pursue this certification.
- **Certified Treasury Professional (CTP):** The certification evaluates a candidate's knowledge in corporate treasury management, including cash and liquidity management, [risk management](#) and capital markets. Candidates with at least two years of experience in corporate finance or a related field are eligible to pursue this certification.
- **Financial Risk Manager (FRM):** The certification tests an individual's knowledge and understanding of financial risk management, including market, credit, operational and liquidity risk. Candidates with an undergraduate degree in a relevant field with some [work experience](#) are eligible for this certification.

No other Swiss Bank department has as many highly educated people as the financial analysis department does. The reason of course is partly the complexity of the analysts' daily work. It is also, however, because analysts need **to be able to present themselves as the ones who are able to understand the market***. When communicating with clients, therefore, they always stress the fact that they have a master's degree, a PhD, or a CFA to underline their symbolic capital. This kind of education also allows them access to certain social networks: this is a very network-oriented job.

***Compare with consultants**

To conclude